

era can even be used outdoors as it is lightweight, has a compact design and comes in a nifty carry bag.

**Price:** Rs 9,000  
**Contact:** Neoteric Informatique  
**Phone:** 022-4172600  
**E-mail:** saxena@neoteric-info.com  
**Web site:** www.acercm.com

## Advance Font Catalog 1.20

Manages fonts effortlessly

This small utility works as your font manager, which lets you catalogue different drives with font files. The Explorer-like interface makes the task easy and the learning curve short. After scanning the drives, the utility shows all the fonts that are installed or saved on a particular drive or media.

This utility allows you to add comments to the different fonts by right-clicking on the font. These comments can be later used to find the fonts on the system. You can search for different fonts on the basis of name, style or category. You can make categories to distinguish between different fonts, which helps reduce the time spent searching for them.

Advance Font Catalog even has multilingual support

**Price:** \$29.95 for one license (approximately Rs 1,470)  
**Web site:** www.wizetech.com

## Neotech NKC-9999A

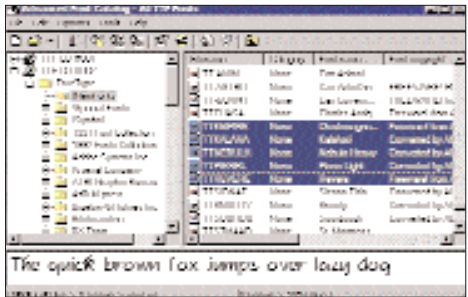
Wireless freedom

This wireless keyboard from Neotech comes with a built-in mouse and a base unit, which receives the infrared signals. The keyboard has a layout similar to that of a laptop and it takes some

**SPECIFICATIONS**  
640x480 pixel resolution, 8 MB built-in memory, built-in flash, USB interface, 0.6 M to infinity focus range

| Acer Digital Camera B+ |       |
|------------------------|-------|
| Performance            | ★★★★★ |
| Build Quality          | ★★★★★ |
| Value for Money        | ★★★★½ |
| Features               | ★★★★½ |
| OVERALL                | ★★★★½ |

for eight different languages. The 15 days evaluation copy can be downloaded from the site, which has all features enabled.



The installation was fast and easy and occupied just 925 KB of hard disk space. It is suitable for layout and design professionals, especially those who use several types of standard and custom-made fonts.

**SPECIFICATIONS**  
925 KB install size, works on Windows 95/98/NT/2000

| Advance Font Catalog 1.20 B+ |       |
|------------------------------|-------|
| Performance                  | ★★★★★ |
| Ease of use                  | ★★★★★ |
| Value for Money              | ★★★★★ |
| Features                     | ★★★★★ |
| OVERALL                      | ★★★★½ |

time for the user to get used to it. The NKC-9999A has a fairly good build quality and comes with grips at both ends, which help you hold it firmly. The compact design also allows for easy portability.

The keyboard needs four 1.5 V AA pencil batteries and the base unit LED blinks every time a key is pressed or when the mouse is used. A disadvantage of infrared is that it requires a clear line of sight and also has a distance limitation. This unit failed when we attempted to use it from a distance of more than 8 feet.

The placement of the buttons makes it ungainly for gaming, especially first person shooter games. Besides, the response of the keyboard is not spontaneous and it takes some time for the action to be actually seen on the screen. This makes it very difficult to scroll in Windows Explorer.

The keyboard is available in dark gray and is lightweight. The base unit has two

**Price:** Rs 335  
**Contact:** Sunder Marketing  
**Phone:** 022-4926015  
**E-mail:** neotech@vsnl.com  
**Web site:** www.sundermarketing.com



PS2 connectors, one each for the mouse and the keyboard. This keyboard is best for those who have a wide format LCD display or a CRT screen larger than 19 inches. An additional button on the mouse makes it easy to perform tasks such as surfing the Net, controlling the volume and so on.

**SPECIFICATIONS**  
Infrared keyboard and mouse, base unit connects to PC through PS2 interface

| Neotech NKC-9999A B+ |       |
|----------------------|-------|
| Performance          | ★★★★★ |
| Build Quality        | ★★★★½ |
| Value for Money      | ★★★★★ |
| Features             | ★★★★★ |
| OVERALL              | ★★★★½ |

## Priya 32x CD-Writer

Slow and unsteady

This 32x CD-Writer from Priya comes bundled with NTI CD-Maker v5.3. The tests were run using this software, as the drive was not detected by Nero v5.5.2.4. Strangely enough, NTI CD-Maker does not allow you to deselect the 'Verify' option. Hence, the CD writing times were heavily skewed. The drive took just 7 minutes 40 seconds to burn a 650 MB CD of assorted data but the total time taken (to

burn as well as finalise) was 16 minutes 46 seconds. The same data when burned on a CD-RW took 17 minutes 46 seconds. What was rather unusual was that it took just a minute more to burn the data at 10x on a CD-RW. When burning on CD-R, even though we selected a speed of 32x, the writer burned at approximately 10x speed.

The drive has integrated burn-proof technology. It, however, crashed continuously in the Nero CD Speed test—we ran this test four times with different CDs, which included audio CDs as well as CDs with assorted data.

The drive features play and volume knobs and the headphone socket on the front

